

Compaq Presario 6235IN

Well! It's a Compaq

The Compaq Presario 6235IN, built on the Pentium 1.9 GHz sports a solid cabinet that combines shades of black and silver, with a DVD/CD-RW combination drive. The innards have the regular 256 MB DDR RAM, a 40 GB hard drive, standard 1.44 MB FDD, six USB ports, four PCI expansion slots, a modem, Ethernet card, on board graphics controller and audio codec.

The hard disk was a bit of a disappointment as it runs at 5,400-rpm. Considering that the price difference between this and a 7,200 rpm drive is marginal, a faster drive should have been in order. Heat is not an issue, as Compaq has taken special care to provide sufficient and noiseless cooling.

The machine comes loaded with Windows XP, along with the necessary software for using the CD-RW. It includes two games—*Fate of the Dragon* and *Project Eden*. It also bundles Microsoft Money 2002, Microsoft Works 6.0 and the Encyclopaedia Britannica 2002 edition CD.

The keyboard has a good

feel and has several hotkeys. The optical mouse too provides a happy mix of ergonomics and sensitivity. The two USB ports are placed in the front for easy access.

In the Content Creation 2001 test, the Presario logged 55.6 which is a good score if your application list consists of Adobe Photoshop, Adobe Premiere, Macromedia DreamWeaver, etc. The *Quake III Arena* scores were also commendable, considering the onboard graphics controller, and were surprisingly, at a resolution of 1024 x 768—better than the scores at a resolution of 800 x 600.

Considering the configuration and make, the PC is reasonably priced. It does take a beating by excluding an AGP slot. Since most people upgrade their computers, this is a sure limiting factor.

SPECIFICATIONS

P4 1.9 GHz, 256 MB PC2100 DDR RAM, 40 GB, 5,400-rpm hard disk drive, 32 x 10 x 12 x 40 DVD/CDRW combination drive, PS/2 optical scroll mouse, Easy Access Internet Keyboard, 1.44 MB FDD, onboard sound codec and graphics controller, Integrated 10/100 Mbps Ethernet controller

Compaq Presario 6235IN A-	
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶▶
Build quality	▶▶▶▶▶▶
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶▶
Features	▶▶▶▶▶▶
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶▶

Price: Rs 50,490
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BackTrak 1.6

Protecting your data

BackTrak 1.6 is a simple backup software aimed at home and small business users. Along with copying the data, it also compresses, encrypts and password pro-

TECTS the data.

The backup procedure consists of three basic steps: what to copy, where to copy and when to copy. All this can be configured once and saved



as profiles to be used automatically every time you take backups. BackTrak can also save a number of versions of the same file.

BackTrak does not have

Price: Rs 5,798
Contact: TechnoPundits Systems Pvt Ltd
Phone: 044-2652 4326
E-mail: jothi_yegneswaran@technopundits.com
Web site: www.technopundits.com

SPECIFICATIONS

Package Contents: Software CD and 12 GB USB hard drive
System Requirements: 100 MHz, Windows 95/98/2000/Me/XP, 32 MB RAM, 20 MB hard disk space

BackTrak 1.6 B+	
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶▶
Ease of Use	▶▶▶▶▶▶
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶▶
Features	▶▶▶▶▶▶
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶▶

Ulead COOL 3D Studio

3D editing for dummies

COOL 3D Studio is very compatible with other animation applications and can export files to Macromedia Flash (.SWF), Read-Text 3D (.r3t) and GIF formats. We used a low-end machine to see just how efficient and quick the program was—an Intel Celeron 466 MHz, 128 MB RAM and a 32 MB Riva TNT2.

The interface is very intuitive and easy to use. Apart from the regular samples in the EasyPalette such as text, graphics, geometric objects and lathe objects, you can insert particle objects such as fire, smoke, snow and bubbles.

One limitation is its inability to directly import the required video and image files—these have to be set as



a host of features. Although the package is supposed to include a 12 GB USB hard drive, we didn't receive one. This drive can be used for storing your backups and carrying them around conveniently.

the background. However, direct importing of graphics files and 3D models are supported.

It provides accurate editing and control of frames using its timeline mode. It is a much improved version with enhancements—exporting of 3D models, timeline mode, setting of various background and camera views, support for locking, disabling and aligning objects.

SPECIFICATIONS

Requirements: Pentium II, 64 MB RAM, 120 MB hard disk space, display card with 4 MB memory, high colour display mode, Windows 98SE/Me/2000/XP, DirectX 8.1
Package contents: One user guide, license agreement, customer registration cards, one installation CD

Ulead COOL 3D Studio A-	
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶▶
Ease of Use	▶▶▶▶▶▶
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶▶
Features	▶▶▶▶▶▶
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶▶

Price: Rs 6,500 + taxes
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